Run Streamlit Apps From Colab without Ngrok

Writing streamlit scripts and Building react apps for learning & testing



Running Streamlit apps in Colab? No need for Ngrok!

I will demonstrate how to use Google Colaboratory to run Streamlit scripts for learning and testing. This is useful because it can help to avoid issues with incompatible libraries and other errors that can arise on our personal computers.

THE FOLLOWING STEPS ALLOW US TO RUN AND CUSTOM OUR APPS

Install streamlit library → Write the script app → Run streamlit in our session → Find our Colab session ports → Clone an application repository and run it → Custom domain with localtunnel

1 Install streamlit library

```
%%capture
!pip install -q streamlit

!pip install --upgrade protobuf  # upgrade protobuf
```

%%capture prevents the output from being displayed in the cell.
The ! runs a single terminal command.

2 Write the script app

```
%%writefile app.py
import streamlit as st
from PIL import Image
favicon = Image.open("favicon.ico")
st.set_page_config(page_title='⭐ Romellfudi Github Star Tracking⭐',
    page_icon=favicon, layout='wide', initial_sidebar_state='auto')
hide_st_style= """
   <style>
    #MainMenu {visibility: hidden;}
    footer {visibility: hidden;}
    header {visibility: hidden;}
     </style>
"""
st.markdown(hide_st_style, unsafe_allow_html=True)
st.title("⭐ Romellfudi Github Star Tracking ⭐")
st.write("Track GitHub stars for your favorite repositories!")
```

The entire code body is saved in app.py — app.py

3 Run streamlit in our session

```
!streamlit run app.py
```

The output updates as you interact with the app.



4 Find our Colab session server ports

The output shows a local network URL, but it's not accessible from our local machine. Let's get the real domain:

```
from google.colab import output
# Using window (opens in a new tab)
display(output.serve_kernel_port_as_window(8501))
```

Open in a new window
https://gritty-coast-418713-uc.a.run.app

You can also use `serve_kernel_port_as_iframe(8501)` to display the app inside the cell.

5 Clone an application repository and run it

```
!git clone https://github.com/tylerjrichards/streamlit_goodreads_app.git
%cd /content/streamlit_goodreads_app
!pip install -q -r requirements.txt
!streamlit run books.py
```

This example runs a Goodreads app that scrapes HTML tables and displays book data.

6 Custom domain with localtunnel

Localtunnel creates a secure tunnel from Colab to the public internet.

```
!streamlit run books.py &>/dev/null& \
 nohup bash -c 'npx localtunnel --port 8501 --subdomain
 romellfudi >  .md' &>/dev/null&
!sleep 10s; cat .md
```

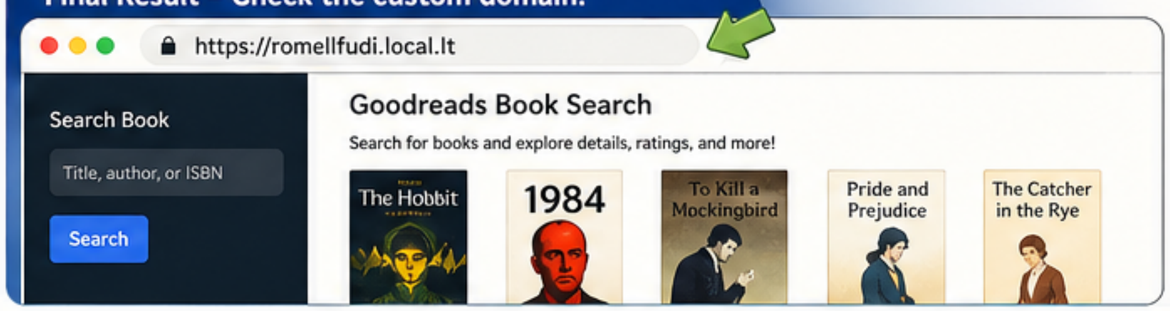
- Run the app in background
- Start localtunnel on port 8501 with custom subdomain
- Wait and print the public URL

Final public localtunnel URL

https://romellfudi.local.lt



Final Result – Check the custom domain!



Conclusion

Colaboratory has everything you need to create an environment to test your React/Streamlit applications for reporting tasks or just training/testing different scripts.

Localtunnel is already integrated with Colaboratory, helping you build any visualization dashboard for Exploratory Data Analysis.



- No Ngrok
- Easy & Fast
- Share Anywhere!